

Topic: The Articles of Faith,**Sub Topic: Belief in Books and Prophets.****Q (a) Write descriptive account of the Muslim belief in the Revealed Books.****[10]**

Structure of Answer		
Para 1	Para 2	Para 3
☐ General introduction as 3 rd Article of Faith.	☐ Need. ☐ Content. ☐ Connection.	☐ Names and Intro ☐ Present status.
Answer		
☐ Iblis's refusal to prostrate to Adam (AS). ☐ His challenge that he will misguide humanity. ☐ Allah's answer that He will guide them back by sending Books and Prophets. ☐ Believing in Holy Books is the third Article of Faith. There are 4 famous books and some unnamed booklets of Hazrat Ibrahim (AS) and Hazrat Musa (AS). ☐ It is necessary for Muslims to believe in certainty and divine status of all other Books along with Holy Quran. ☐ "He has sent down upon you, [O Muhammad], the Book in truth, confirming what was before it. And He revealed the Torah and the Gospel" [03:03]		
☐ Books were necessary to clarify dos and don'ts. ☐ Books have been sent as a syllabus of exam that is being conducted and result will be declared on Judgement day. ☐ Believing in that divine guidance and acting upon it is the key to success herein and hereafter. ☐ These divine Books contain the guidance and solution for spiritual, moral, social, political and other problems. ☐ All books generally and Holy Quran particularly has amazing knowledge which doesn't get out dated. ☐ As described by Hazrat Abdullah bin Abbas: "Recite Quran, it contains the knowledge of past and future" ☐ The basic content of all books is almost same. They all contain teachings about Oneness, Prophet-hood, Barzakh, Judgement Day, Resurrection, Heaven and Hell and motivation for doing good deeds while restraining from bad deeds. ☐ "And We did not send any messenger except [speaking] in the language of his people to state clearly for them" [14: 4] ☐ This means that Prophets were sent to every nation and possibly a lot of them brought written scriptures for their nations which must be in their native languages. As Muslims, we should believe in all of them. Quran approves previous scriptures. ☐ Ref: "And We have revealed to you, [O Muhammad], the Book in truth, confirming that which preceded it of the Scripture and as a criterion over it" [5: 48]		
☐ TORAH: It was given to Hazrat Moses (Musa). The Quran mentions that it was sent to the Bani Israel. ☐ PSALM (Zabur): It was sent to Hazrat Dawood (David). ☐ GOSPEL (Injil): It was sent to Hazrat Esa (Jesus). Gospel as a word means good news. It tells the life story of Hazrat Esa and gives some ethical advice. Since Christians accept Torah also as a holy book, they take Torah as reference for legal arrangements. They brought together some parts from Torah, Gospel and Psalms and called it the Holy Bible. ☐ The Quran: is the last holy book sent to the last Prophet Hazrat Muhammad (PBUH) through revelation chapter by chapter and verse by verse in 23 years. With the Quran, the chain of heavenly books was completed and the other books were abrogated. ☐ "This day have I perfected your religion for you, completed my favor upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion." [05:03] ☐ Allah (SWT) claimed the responsibility of Safe guarding Quran which ensures that there won't be a minor change in Holy Quran. ☐ But there are possibilities of editing and alteration in previous books as they were not guarded by Allah and even their followers did not put true efforts to ensure safety of their divine books.		



Q (a) Write about Muslims' belief in Prophets.

Structure of Answer		
Para 1	Para 2	Para 3
☐ General introduction as 4 th Article of Faith.	☐ Purpose ☐ Characteristics ☐ Qualities ☐ Miracles.	☐ Number of Prophets ☐ Names and Specialties ☐ Comparison ☐ Prophets for every nation.
Answer		
☐ Iblis's refusal to prostrate to Adam (AS). ☐ His challenge that he will misguide humanity. ☐ Allah's answer that He will guide them back by sending Books and Prophets. 📖 Ref: "For We send our messengers only to give good news to the righteous people and to warn the evil doers" [06:48] ☐ Believing in all Prophets is an integral Article of Faith, instructed by Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and Allah (SWT).		
☐ Prophets guide humanity. ☐ They establish connection between Allah and His creation. ☐ Allah does not punish any nation without sending Prophets. 📖 "And never would We punish until We sent a messenger" [17:15] ☐ Prophets are human beings. ☐ Every single one of them received natural birth (With few exceptions) like other human beings; they ate, drank and breathe. They had families, friends and other relationships. ☐ Another important thing about Prophethood is that it cannot be earned or asked. 📖 "That is the bounty of Allah, which He gives to whom He wills, and Allah is the possessor of great bounty. [62:4] ☐ Prophets were perfect human beings in every sense. Theoretically, they're Innocent and even before getting the rank of Prophethood their early lives were also perfect. Like prophet Muhammad (PBUH) in his early 40 years used to be called truthful and trustworthy. ☐ Prophets have miracles and their miracles dominate the trend of their respective era. ✓ Like in the Era of Moses, magic was the trend. So, Moses was given the Miracle of Stick that would turn into a snake in order to dominate their magical powers. ✓ Jesus dominated the trend of superior medical science by treating incurable diseases and resurrecting the dead ones by Allah's command. ✓ Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) broke the pride of Arabs about their linguistic superiority by Quran that is a master piece of Arabic Grammar.		
☐ According to a tradition 124000 thousand Prophets were sent by Allah (SWT). But Quran only mentions 26 of them with different duties, books, suhuf (Booklets), shariah and different distinctions. ☐ Like Moses is called Speaker of Allah as he spoke to Allah Almighty while he was at mount Toor. Abraham is called Grand Father of Prophets as there were hundreds of Prophet in Abraham's family. Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) was the seal of Prophets while Hazrat Adam was the first one. 📖 Ref: "Those messengers - some of them We caused to exceed others" [2:253] ☐ But nobody is allowed to compare them with each other as all of them are equally respected to us. No Muslim can be Muslim without believing and giving mandatory respect to all previous prophets. 📖 Ref: "We make no distinction between any of them, and we are Muslims [in submission] to Him" [2:136] ☐ A very important thing to be remembered about Prophets is that Allah has sent Prophets in every region of this world as everyone needed divine guidance equally. 📖 Ref: "And We did not send any messenger except [speaking] in the language of his people to state clearly for them..." [14:4] ☐ Their Books or stories might be extinct but we are supposed to believe in them and keep in Mind that they all carried a same message that included belief in the oneness of God, Good Conduct and Belief in life after death.		